THE COMMIT BOOK

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For NCAA Division I hopefuls, grades 9 to 11. Rules checked 2026-11-05 against the 2026-27 NCAA Division I Manual.

Edition 2026-27 · Rules checked 2026-11-05 · Education, not legal advice. No outcome promised.

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> Education, not legal advice. No promise of eligibility, a scholarship or a roster spot. The Eligibility Center makes the final call. D2 has its own academic standards; check them separately.

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1. WHY THESE TWO

Most recruiting dates are openings. Starting later costs nothing. These two are different: miss them and senior-year classes can't repair the damage.

2. DEADLINE 1: THE 10/7 LOCK

Before the first day of the seventh semester (start of senior year), finish **10 of 16 core courses**, and **7 of those 10** must be English, math or natural/physical science. Those 10 grades lock for GPA purposes. Your high school's calendar sets the exact date. (D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1(b))

Cost if missed: can block qualifier status and first-year competition.

3. DEADLINE 2: THE 16-CORE FINISH

A qualifier graduates high school with a **minimum 2.300 core GPA** (4.000 scale) in **16 core courses** (D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1(a)):

AREA	YEARS
English	4
Math (Algebra I or higher)	3
Natural or physical science	2
Additional English, math or science	1
Social science	2

AREA	YEARS
Additional academic (any above, world language, philosophy, nondoctrinal religion)	4

Computer science with significant programming may count as math or science where it meets graduation requirements (14.3.1.1(a)). A course must also meet the criteria in Bylaw 14.3.1.3 and appear on your school's NCAA list. The final transcript must reach the Eligibility Center.

A transcript GPA isn't the core GPA. Electives don't count.

4. THE ELIGIBILITY CENTER ACCOUNT

- Free Profile Page: fine early. It's not certification.
- Certification account: $110 domestic (fee waivers possible). Required before any D1 official visit (D1 Bylaw 13.6.3). Our recommended date: August of the summer before junior year.
- From April 1 of senior year: request final amateurism certification (Eligibility Center procedure).

5. COUNSELOR MEETING SCRIPT (BOOK IT IN 9TH OR 10TH GRADE)

> We're planning for NCAA Division I eligibility. Can we check every course my student has taken and plans to take against our school's NCAA-approved list? We need 10 core courses, 7 in English, math or science, done before senior year, and 16 total with a 2.3 core GPA. Which planned classes are not on the list? Who sends final transcripts to the Eligibility Center?

Bring the worksheet below. Leave with a written four-year plan.

6. CORE-COURSE WORKSHEET

#	COURSE	AREA	GRADE LEVEL	ON NCAA LIST? (Y/N)	GRADE	BEFORE 7TH SEMESTER?
1		English				
2		English				
3		English				
4		English				
5		Math				
6		Math				
7		Math				
8		Science				
9		Science				
10		Extra Eng/Math/Sci				
11		Social science				
12		Social science				
13		Additional				

#	COURSE	AREA	GRADE LEVEL	ON NCAA LIST? (Y/N)	GRADE	BEFORE 7TH SEMESTER?
14		Additional				
15		Additional				
16		Additional				

10/7 check: count Y rows done before senior year ___ /10. Of those, English/math/science ___ /7.

7. CORE GPA, STEP BY STEP

1. Use only the 16 rows above (on the list).
2. Convert each grade: A=4, B=3, C=2, D=1 (your school's scale may weight honors; the Eligibility Center applies its own rules).
3. Multiply by credit (full year = 1.0, semester = 0.5).
4. Sum the points, divide by total credits. Target: 2.300 or higher. Leave margin.

8. YEAR-BY-YEAR CHECKLIST

9th grade: [ ] counselor meeting [ ] save school's NCAA course list [ ] worksheet started

10th: [ ] recheck plan by Nov 15 (recommended) [ ] free Profile Page [ ] fix any off-list course now

Summer before 11th: [ ] certification account ($110 / waiver) [ ] send transcript after junior year

11th: [ ] 10/7 count before senior year starts [ ] core GPA calculated

12th: [ ] remaining cores scheduled [ ] Apr 1: final amateurism request [ ] final transcript sent after graduation

9. SOURCES

- 2026-27 NCAA Division I Manual, Bylaws 14.3.1.1 (revised 6/24/26 eff. 8/1/26), 14.3.1.3, 13.6.3: https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008 — checked 2026-11-05.
- Eligibility Center registration checklist: https://fs.ncaa.org/Docs/eligibility_center/Student_Resources/Registration_Checklist.pdf
- Eligibility Center brochure: https://fs.ncaa.org/Docs/eligibility_center/Student_Resources/IE_Brochure.pdf
- Final amateurism request: https://fs.ncaa.org/Docs/eligibility_center/Student_Resources/How_to_Request_Final_Amateurism_Certification.pdf